Introduction to the Economics of Development

Project Information

Luke Heath Milsom

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luke_m@kuleuven.be

The project

- 12 min presentation, up to 8 min questions.
- I don't care about the format or who presents in your group.
- Present in English
- Deadline = 7.12 midday. You must present what you submit exactly.
- Every group member will get the same grade.

What I'm expecting from the small group paper

- Abstraction and Empirics are not necessary (or sufficient) to achieve good marks, but they might help...
- Choose one of the questions covered in the course — answer some small part of it.
- You can use data, provide some figures etc. You can use some abstraction and modeling but be warned, this is hard to do well.
- You have to come up with a question and thesis on your own, but can re-use evidence from others.

Marking the project

Equal weighting.

- Novelty and clarity of question
- Understanding of the relevant literature
- Use of course material
- Quality of argument — does the evidence match the question
- Presentation

Structure

1. Clearly defined research question
2. Position within the literature (small lit review)
3. Description of the argument and evidence you will bring forth.
   - Explanation as to why this can answer your question.
4. The evidence (main part)
5. Conclusion — come to a value judgment and answer your posed question

Literature

- I expect you to cite relevant sources
- You should demonstrate an understanding of the relevant literature and how your project fits within it
- At the end there should be a bibliography

Example questions and evidence

1. Q: How Natural Resources are Instrumentalised by Authoritarian Regimes.
   Evidence: Look at 3 resource-rich (Nigeria, Angola, Gabon) and 3 resource-poor countries (Benin, Madagascar, Mali). Regression analysis combined with in-depth case studies and discursive reasoning.

2. Q: Climate Change and Coffee Trade: Implications on Vietnam's Exports and Dutch Import Prices.
   Evidence: Regress Dutch coffee import prices on weather shocks in Vietnam.

3. Q: How does education influence poverty traps in India?
   Evidence: Formalise through the poverty trap theory plus Indian case study.

4. Q: How does gender inequality in education contribute to the persistence of poverty?
   Evidence: In depth use of existing literature and a clearly articulated theory of change.